

and finally Bitcoin ATMs are now being rolled out. What more of a justification could one need to deem Bitcoins as worthy of investment.

The situation in India

While mining and trading has been going on for quite some time and that too at a level similar to what most countries have, the prospect of exchanging Bitcoins into real world cash has been more or less difficult. Ever since the whole hullabaloo over black money, trading is somewhat risky as it does put traders under the scrutiny of the authorities. There wouldn't be anything wrong with it but reports of Bitcoins being used for funding the cause of anti-social elements has led to some inconvenience. The recent notice by the RBI [can be read here http://rbi.org.in/scripts/BS_PressReleaseDisplay.aspx?prid=30247] has led to a lot of Indian Bitcoin exchanges shutting shop or temporarily suspending services. Few of the said services have restarted their services but the uncertainty of trusting a new player in the market always exists.

Going about it all

Now that the gloomy, boring and rather discouraging part about trading is over, let's get into the thick of the whole trading business. Before you start with anything you'd want someplace to store your Bitcoins. While real world currency has a whole centralised system in place the digital currency is more decentralised.

Wallet

The first step is to get a wallet for yourself. The wallet is from where you send and receive Bitcoins. There are multiple websites and software that allow you to set up a wallet. But you need to remember that with all the crackdown on various services a third party system could go down any day and with that all your Bitcoins will disappear. That's a worst case scenario but something that has been happening. There are three types of wallets you can go with.



1. Software based

These are software that you download onto your system and let's you start immediately. There are plenty of software avail-